

Aussie Primary Academy

Year 6 Science – Biological Sciences: Living Things & Their Environment

I can: explain how adaptations help living things survive in their environment!

Name: _____

Date: _____

Page 1 – Let's Explore!

ACARA V9.0 - AC9S6U01

Big Idea

Living things have **adaptations** – special features or behaviours – that help them survive, grow and reproduce in their environment. Adaptations can be physical (like a camel's hump) or behavioural (like migrating birds).

1 Vocabulary Bank

adaptation

environment

survival

habitat

behavioural

physical

camouflage

migration

2 Sort into physical or behavioural adaptation

thick fur, hibernation, camouflage colouring, migration, sharp claws, webbed feet, playing dead, storing food

Physical

Behavioural

3 Match the Australian animal to its adaptation

Koala

→

digests tough eucalyptus leaves

Kangaroo

→

powerful legs for long-distance hopping

Camel (feral, outback)

→

stores fat to survive without water

4 True or False

a) An adaptation always has to be a physical body part. True / False

b) Animals in the same habitat can have very different adaptations. True / False

c) Adaptations help a species survive over many generations. True / False

5 Choose an Australian animal and draw it, labelling 3 adaptations that help it survive



6 Investigate: What if the environment changed?

If a habitat became much drier, what adaptation might help an animal survive there? Explain your reasoning.



7 Challenge Question

Why might an adaptation that helps an animal in one environment be useless (or harmful) in a different environment? _____

Great Science Thinking!

High-Five Tips for Parents & Teachers

- Visit a zoo, wildlife park or nature reserve together and ask 'what adaptation is this animal using right now?' for a hands-on link.
- Use Australian native animals specifically — they provide rich, locally relevant adaptation examples (koalas, kangaroos, echidnas).
- Distinguish clearly between something an animal is BORN with (physical) and something it DOES (behavioural) — this is a common mix-up.
- Connect adaptations to climate change discussions your child may already be hearing about, in an age-appropriate way.
- Encourage 'what if' thinking — reasoning about hypothetical environment changes builds genuine scientific thinking, not just recall.

✓ Answer Key

2. Physical: thick fur, camouflage colouring, sharp claws, webbed feet. Behavioural: hibernation, migration, playing dead, storing food
3. Koala→digests eucalyptus, Kangaroo→powerful legs, Camel→stores fat
4. a) False b) True c) True
7. An adaptation is suited to specific conditions (e.g. thick fur suits cold, not heat) — in a different environment it may not help or could even be a disadvantage